

THE GREEN RISK

► India was largely self-sufficient in pulses and edible oils a few decades ago and the demand for chemical fertilisers was low until the Green Revolution

► The West Asia war has brought to fore the policy distortions and practices

► The Economic Survey 2025-26 notes that recent incentives for ethanol blending have distorted input and output markets

► The PM-AASHA scheme, launched in 2018, to give price support for Kharif and Rabi crops, spent only ₹6,941 crore in FY26 (RE) and has a budget of ₹7,200 crore for FY27 (BE)

FOOD SECURITY'S FOREIGN CRUTCH

WITH APPROPRIATE POLICY RESPONSES, IMPORT DEPENDENCE IN EDIBLE OILS, PULSES AND FERTILISERS CAN BE REVERSED

BY PRASANNA MOHANTY

PHOTO BY GETTY IMAGES



ALONG THE FAULTLINES

the West Asia conflict has exposed, perhaps the most consequential is India's vulnerabilities on the food and nutrition security front. Imported edible oils, pulses and fertilisers are leaving India's farm economy vulnerable to global shocks. The blockade of the Strait of Hormuz has highlighted these secondary risks, exposing India's growing reliance on overseas inputs for its food security.

Though the Strait of Hormuz directly chokes only a portion of India's fertiliser supply—accounting for 20–30% of urea, 30% of Diammonium Phosphate (DAP) and 50% of Liquefied Natural Gas (LNG) as feedstock—its secondary impact has disrupted the supply chains and affected the cost of edible oils and pulses.

Given that India was largely self-sufficient in pulses and edible oils till a few decades ago and the demand for chemical fertilisers was low until